LAURA BEATRIZ GOMEZ CELY

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Professional Experience

International Monetary Fund (IMF)

Senior Research Analyst | Western Hemisphere Department, Brazil and Front Team | Washington, DC, USA | 2025 – Present

- Conduct exchange rate decompositions for Brazil and Colombia, and present findings to the Brazilian authorities.
- Contribute to the Brazil monetary expectations project by collecting and preparing relevant data, developing the database infrastructure, and applying local projections to assess the transmission of monetary and fiscal policy shocks.
- Analyze labor data from Uruguay to understand the impact of the reduction in working hours from some economic sectors on wages and productivity.
- Monitor and analyze macro-financial indicators to inform policy recommendations.
- Support the preparation of macroeconomic reports, including the World Economic Outlook and Article IV, through analytical work and data collection for Brazil and Uruguay.
- Analytical and data collection support in macroeconomic reports such as the World Economic Outlook and Article IV.

Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)

Senior Consultant in Econometrics and Public Policy | Connectivity, Market and Finance | Washington, DC, USA | 2023 – 2025

- Lead the development and application of econometric and data-driven methodologies, including structural models and instrumental variables for knowledge products focusing on financial conditions and innovation needs faced by SMEs and sectors.
- Support the development of Dashboards with Satellite Data defining key indicators for Public Development Banks and Financial Institutions in the monitoring and evaluation of climate and deforestation risks in their portfolio. Spatial econometrics for the construction maps using ArgGis
- Text analysis using machine learning classification for knowledge products.
- Design pilots and experiments to enhance data collection and analytical methods resolving operational bottlenecks and improving Monitoring and Evaluation Results (M&E).

Economics Consultant | Gender, Diversity, and Inclusion Division | Colombia | 2022 – 2023

- Constructed socio-economic indicators disaggregated by gender and disability status, including labor market participation, educational attendance, and domestic violence metrics, for use in policy evaluation and monitoring frameworks.
- Contribute to gender-based violence research including the development of the theory of change, research questions, identification of indicators, methodologies, and the synthesis of lessons learned.
- Contributed to identifying cost-effective interventions for gender-based violence in Latin America and the Caribbean.
- Collaborated in the design and evaluation of a laboratory experiment to estimate prejudice towards people with disabilities, immigrants, and LGBTQ+ people in work environments.
- Text analysis using machine learning classification for sentiment analysis in terms of LGBTQ+ and people with disabilities

Economics Consultant | Citizen Security and Justice | Colombia | 2021 – 2022

- Elaborated research papers, reports, and presentations. Identified, compiled, and organized databases on Gender Based Violence and Crime. Performed econometric and statistical analyses. Reviewed documents and prepared survey instruments.

Food and Agricultural Organization (FAO)

Economics Consultant | Agrifood Economics Division | Colombia | 2023

- Analyzed the impact of inflationary shocks on Peruvian households' consumption decisions using the QUAIDS methodology.
- Evaluated changes in household nutrition due to inflation, considering internal household structures.

Economist Consultant | Agrifood Economics Division | Colombia | 2021

- Used Stochastic Frontier Analysis to improve food security in Paraguay by building typologies of rural micro-regions.
- Spatial econometrics for the construction of typology maps using ArgGis.
- Trained the Ministry of Agriculture in applying Frontier Analysis methodology for policy selection to protect Paraguay's food security.
- Prepare documentation to disseminate the results of the model to contribute to a more inclusive agricultural transformation in Paraguay.

Colombian Chamber of Infrastructure

Senior Economist | Vice President of Economic Affairs | Colombia | 2018 – 2019

- Conducted studies on MSMEs in the infrastructure sector and regulations that foster innovation practices.
- Contribute to the design of public policies such as the definition of the theory of change in the road, port and air infrastructure sector.
- Created a Corporate Governance Index for each MSMEs to identify whether the company complies with good corporate practices in terms of highest corporate body, directors, management control and transparency. This allows SMEs to access more and better (cheaper) financial services with local and international entities.
- Monitored the execution of projects in the 4G Program, developing an interactive dashboard for project tracking using R and Waze data.
- Economic analysis of the infrastructure sector, including the forecast of infrastructure GDP.

Ministry of Finance

Economist | Macroeconomic Division | Colombia | 2018

- Estimated Debt using IMF frameworks. Performed debt decomposition analysis.
- Contributed to the Ministry's flagship publication 'Medium-Term Fiscal Framework 2018' in terms of debt quantification and analysis following IMF frameworks.

Fedesarrollo

Research Assistant | Colombia | 2017

- Analysis of different Colombian sectors (Public Finance, Health, Education, and Justice) in terms of expenses and investment using data and statistical tools such as Stata and R for the Commission of Investment and Expenses.
- Elaboration of a book with all the diagnoses and recommendations of the different Colombian sectors.

Universidad de los Andes

Research Assistant | CEDE | Colombia | 2016-2017

- Applied impact evaluation methodologies to social projects.
- Performed a DSGE model using analytical tools in Matlab to identify channels of conflict that affect economic growth.

Assistant Professor | Master of Economics | Colombia | 2016-2019

- Game Theory
- Mathematics for Economist

Education

Tilburg University | Tilburg, Netherlands | 2020-2021

- Master of Science in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics
  Thesis: Fertility, Birth Intervals, and Stunting in under five children in Bangladesh

Universidad de los Andes | Colombia | 2009-2017

- Master Research in Economics.
  Thesis: 40 x 40 Day Effects on repetition: empirical evidence for public schools in Bogota
- Bachelor of Science (BS) in Economics
- Bachelor of Arts (BA) in Political Science

Publications

- The Effects of Product Differentiation and Process Innovation on Credit Rationing. 2026. (Coauthored with Joachin A., Tamola A., Fernandez C.). Inter-American Development Bank. http://dx.doi.org/10.18235/0013974
- Birth intervals and stunting in Bangladesh, Athens Journal of Demography & Anthropology, 1(2), 77-96. 2025 (Coauthored with Saha, U.R, Gomez Cely, L. Van Wesenbeeck, L. and Van Soest). https://doi.org/10.30958/ajda.1-2-1
- Post-conflict Economy and Security (1st ed.). 2018 (Coauthored with Zuleta H.). Universidad de los Andes, Colombia.
- Conflict, Sectors, Regions and Growth. 2016 (Coauthored with Zuleta H.). Documentos CEDE, Universidad de los Andes, Facultad de Economía, CEDE.

Working Papers

- Welfare Effects of Food Price Increase: Evidence for Peru. 2026. (with C. Morales and E. Josh). Forthcoming. Selected for presentation (Lightning Session) at the 2026 AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO, July 26-28, 2026.
- Decomposing Brazil's Exchange Rate Movements. 2026. (with C. Evans). IMF Working Paper, forthcoming.

Policy Work

- IMF Brazil Article IV Consultation (2026): Conducted exchange rate decomposition analysis and contributed to macroeconomic surveillance and policy assessment
- Expanding Opportunities: Policies for Gender Equality and Inclusion. Inter-American Development Bank, 2024 (Contributor).
- Medium-Term Fiscal Framework (Marco Fiscal de Mediano Plazo). Ministry of Finance, Colombia, 2018 (Contributor).

References

- Daniel Leigh | Assistant Director | IMF | DLeigh@imf.org
- Santiago Perez Vincent | Senior Economist | IADB | santiagoper@iadb.org
- Cristian Morales | Senior Economist | FAO | Cristian.MoralesOpazo@fao.org
- Maria Carmen Fernandez Diez| Senior Economist | IADB | carmenfe@iadb.org
- Hernando Zuleta | Dean Department of Economics | Universidad de los Andes | h.zuleta@uniandes.edu.co

Additional Information

Certifications: MicroMaster in Social Program Evaluation | Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) | 2024
Software: MS Office, Power Bi, STATA, R, Python, Matlab, LaTeX.
Languages: Native Speaker of Spanish; Professional Proficiency in English; Basic Proficiency in German.